

2026 Brisbane Digital Delivery Salary & Rates Guide

What business analysis, change, testing and development capability really costs in the Queensland market — and a simpler way to buy it.

Business Analysis

Change Management

Test Management

Software Development

The Brisbane market in 2026

Queensland's digital investment pipeline keeps delivery skills in structural demand. Government digital programs and university transformation agendas are standing up new projects, and with them sustained demand for business analysts, change specialists and development capability. Published recruiter guides put experienced contractors in a wide band — and what a client actually pays is wider still, because agency engagement typically adds a further margin on top of the contractor's rate.

**\$900–
1,250/day**

Published QLD contractor band for senior business analysts and change managers.

**+10–
20%**

Typical agency mark-up a client pays on top of the contractor's published rate.

\$1,300/day

Top of the published QLD band for a technical lead — senior development capability commands a premium.

3 guides

Independent published sources behind every figure in this guide.

Where demand is

Projects and programs are being stood up again across the east coast, with demand strongest for business analysts with specialist skill sets, organisational change capability, and data and development skills. Queensland's public investment in digital initiatives continues to expand.

What it means for buyers

Senior delivery talent is contested, and buying it role-by-role through agencies stacks margin on every seat. Buyers get better value engaging a coordinated squad under one agreement, with quality oversight built in rather than bought separately.

How to read the rates

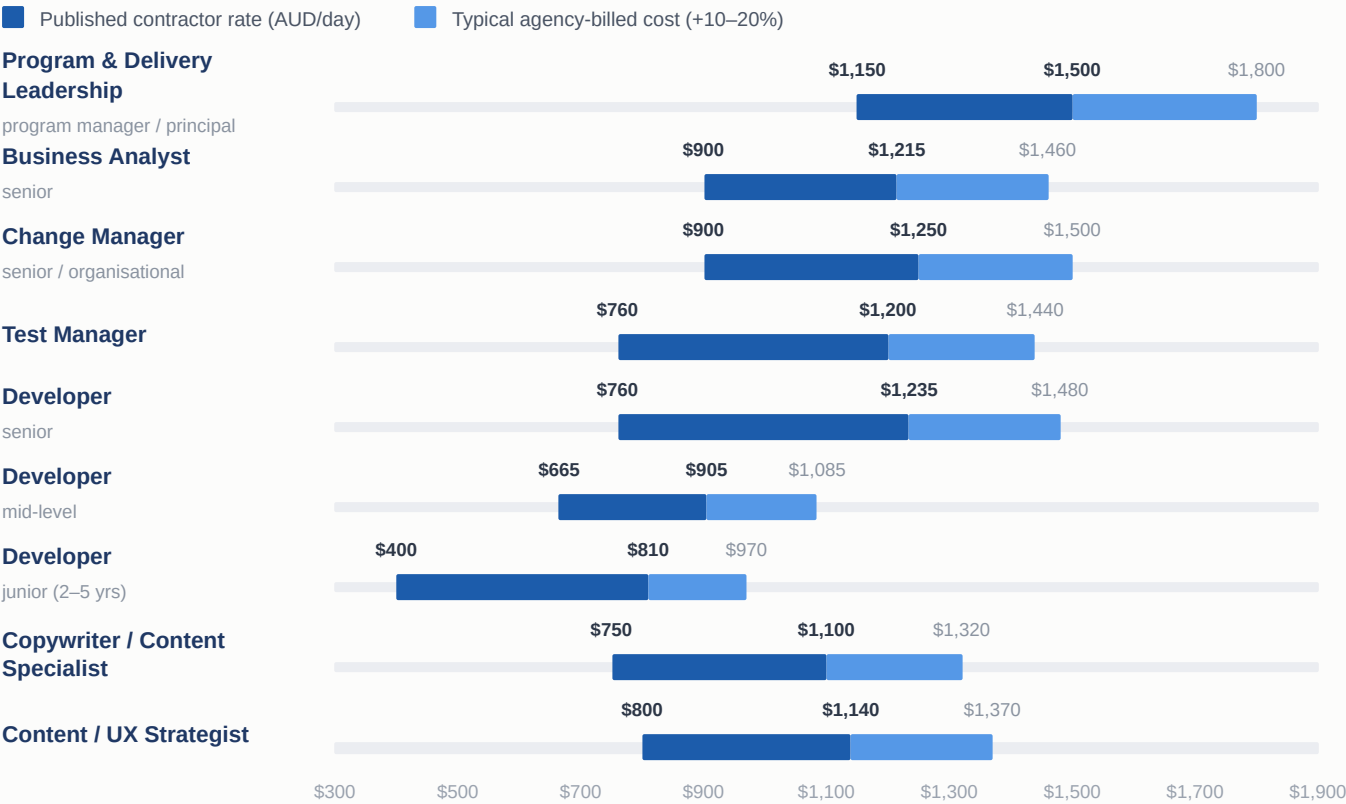
Published guide figures are what the contractor receives. The lighter band in the chart overleaf adds the 10–20% an agency typically bills on top — the truer picture of client-side cost per seat.

“Buying delivery capability seat-by-seat means paying agency margin seat-by-seat. A coordinated squad under one agreement puts that money back into delivery.”

Sky Lavelle — Principal, Vantage Meridian

What each role costs per day

Contractor day rates for experienced (senior-band) practitioners, drawn from published 2025–26 recruiter guides for Queensland and Brisbane, with the typical agency-billed cost shown alongside.



Role	QLD contractor rate	Typical agency-billed cost
Program & Delivery Leadership	\$1,150 – \$1,500	\$1,325 – \$1,800
Business Analyst (senior)	\$900 – \$1,215	\$1,035 – \$1,460
Change Manager (senior)	\$900 – \$1,250	\$1,035 – \$1,500
Test Manager	\$760 – \$1,200	\$875 – \$1,440
Developer — senior	\$760 – \$1,235	\$875 – \$1,480
Developer — mid-level	\$665 – \$905	\$765 – \$1,085
Developer — junior (2–5 yrs)	\$400 – \$810	\$460 – \$970
Copywriter / Content Specialist	\$750 – \$1,100	\$865 – \$1,320
Content / UX Strategist	\$800 – \$1,140	\$920 – \$1,370

Sources: Peoplebank Salary Guide, August 2025 (QLD contract tables); Salary Guide for 2025, The Network (Brisbane chapter — Project Services & Transformation, Software Engineering and Testing tables); Hays Salary Guide FY25–26 (QLD, permanent salary benchmarks used for context). Agency-billed cost applies the typical 15–20% agency margin to published contractor rates. All figures AUD per day, exclusive of GST.

One team. One contract. One rate.

Vantage Meridian provides delivery capability through an established network of experienced practitioners, engaged directly under Vantage Meridian master agreements and delivering under hands-on senior principal oversight. Every rate below is fully inclusive — insurance, engagement management and quality assurance built in.

Principal Consultant Program & Delivery Leadership	Program and project leadership, delivery recovery, business cases and options analysis, executive stakeholder management, vendor and RFP management, delivery assurance.	\$1,550 per day, ex GST
Developer — Junior	Feature development and defect resolution under senior technical direction; unit testing, documentation, full participation in sprint ceremonies.	\$880 per day, ex GST
Developer — Mid-level	Frontend, CRM and backend development within an established technical direction; sprint delivery, code review participation, documentation.	\$1,120 per day, ex GST
Developer — Senior	Complex feature and integration delivery, technical design input, mentoring of junior and mid-level developers, production support.	\$1,360 per day, ex GST
Business Analyst	Requirements elicitation and analysis, process mapping, user stories and acceptance criteria, stakeholder workshops, options and business case support.	\$1,400 per day, ex GST
Change Manager	Change impact assessment, stakeholder engagement and communications, training strategy and delivery, adoption measurement.	\$1,400 per day, ex GST
Test Manager	Test strategy and planning, test team coordination, defect triage and reporting, UAT management, go-live readiness assessment.	\$1,400 per day, ex GST
Copywriter / Content Specialist	Web, campaign and product copy; content design and tone-of-voice application; editing, content migration and publication support within delivery programs.	\$840 per day, ex GST
Content / UX Strategist	Content strategy and information architecture, UX research and journey mapping, content design standards, experience strategy within delivery programs.	\$1,120 per day, ex GST

Every rate includes

Professional indemnity & public liability insurance · engagement management · senior principal oversight and quality assurance on every engagement · a single point of accountability.

Engagement terms

Rates valid 90 days from issue · delivery on site or remote, equipment provided · fixed-price and outcome-based pricing available for defined scopes · one contract, one monthly invoice.